Preparing and Delivering A Message

Building A Message

CHOOSING A MESSAGE

- Pray, pray and pray again
- Begin with a passage
- Begin with a topic/theme
- (Remember the Church Calendar)

CHOOSING A MESSAGE

- Know your audience:
  - Issues they are wrestling with
  - Be aware of current affairs
  - Felt needs of people
  - Issues that you see are needed
  - Talk to ‘insiders’

PREPARATION

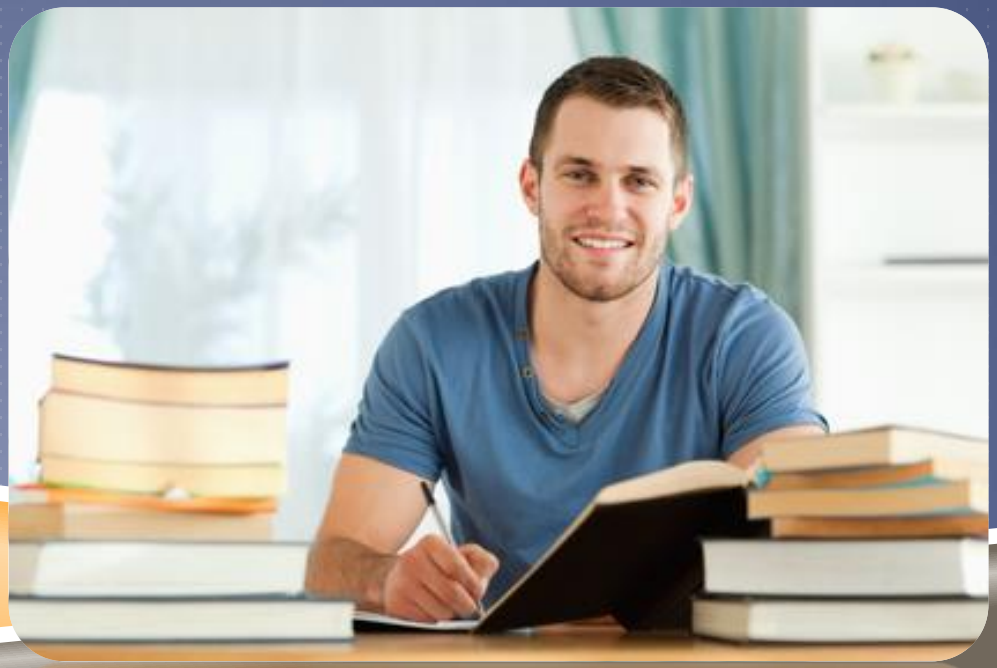
- Pray, Pray and Pray again
- Study hard - the key is observation
- Get to know passage/s really well

PREPARATION

- Who and What questions
- Think application
- Write all ideas down on paper/mind map

PREPARATION

- Write out the goal of the message
- Define it into one simple sentence
- Look at commentaries!



BUILDING A MESSAGE - THE GRID

- Essential that the message has structure.
- Different paradigms:
  - Hook - Look - Took
  - Tell them what you want to say, say it, tell them what you have said!
  - Introduction, point 1 - 2 - 3 - Conclusion

THE GRID

Bridge

Problem/Need/Issue

Solution/Answer/Application

Conclusion/Take away

THE GRID

Bridge: Relationship connection

Hook: Reason to listen

Content of message

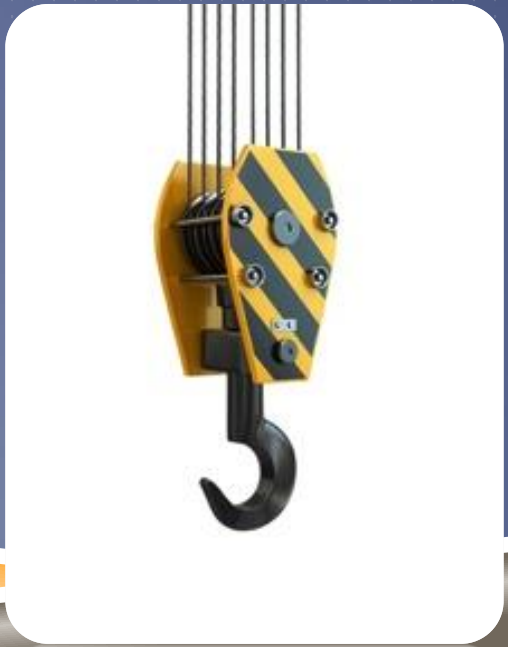
What they should do

BRIDGE

- This crosses the gulf
- Done in the first few minutes
- It could be:A funny story
- Sharing about yourself
- About the meeting so far
- Comment on your introduction

PROBLEM/HOOK: REASON TO LISTEN

- This is the introduction, setting the scene
- Key point of the message
- All the people listening to you



PROBLEM/HOOK: REASON TO LISTEN

- Question - is this worth listening to?
- Subject in form of a problem or need?
- Give the people a reason to listen

CONTENT OF THE MESSAGE

- Needs structure-outline
- Build on introduction
- Lay any foundation needed to understand passage: tell story / illustrate
- Message will be mostly application

CONTENT OF THE MESSAGE

- Think about illustrations:
- Stories
- Visual aids
- Activities
- Personal life testimony / examples

CONTENT OF THE MESSAGE

- Engage with issues in life
- Engage with issues of society
- Show how Bible (God!) is the answer to the issues

CONCLUSION/TAKEAWAY

- Bring closure to the message
- It is easy to finish your message but not stop!
- You have most peoples attention

CONCLUSION/TAKEAWAY

- Reinforce what has been said
- Use a story to illustrate
- Give a testimony

GIVE A TAKE AWAY

- Something that they can take away to DO to apply the word.
- Help them put feet on the message.
- Invite people for prayer

EXAMPLE 1

- Example of people I know who have drifted
- Scripture reference 1Kings 3-11
- Paint verbal picture of Solomon in success 1Kings 3-10
- Read 1Kings 11:1-8

EXAMPLE 1

- Deut 17:14-20
- Three dangers:
- Beware of success and not needing to depend on God
- Beware of a shifting world view
- Cultivate accountable friendships

EXAMPLE 2

- Given passage to preach on: Eph 1:15-19
- Theme: Our Identity in Christ
- Talk about our identity
- What determines our identity
- Context of Eph 1:15-19 is 1:3-14 Our being “In Christ”
- Importance of the prayer!